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Education and employment

1.1 ISSUES IN EDUCATION

IN THIS UNIT

GRAMMAR

- the continuous aspect
- the perfect aspect

VOCABULARY

- issues in education
- reporting what others say
- suffixes (adjectives)
- abbreviations

SCENARIO

- stating requirements, saying what is essential and desirable
- choosing an intern

STUDY SKILLS

- self-awareness

WRITING SKILLS

- a covering letter



Education costs money, but then so does ignorance. Claus Moser (b. 1922), German-born British academic



SPEAKING AND VOCABULARY

1a Complete the opinions with the words in the box.

assessment curriculum dumbing down elitism
interpersonal skills plagiarism streaming

- 'The most important aspect of education is the curriculum, or subjects which are taught.'
- 'Frequent examinations are a much more reliable and useful way of measuring performance than continuous assessment'
- 'Streaming is an excellent idea because it enables students with a similar ability to work at the same pace.'
- 'Education is not about developing your interpersonal skills, but about learning facts.'
- 'Private education creates elitism and encourages inequality in society, which is absolutely disgusting.'
- 'Copying someone else's ideas, plagiarism, cheating and buying qualifications is sometimes necessary.'
- 'It's easier to get good grades nowadays because education is dumbing down. Qualifications are worth less than in the past.'

1b Which opinions do you agree or disagree with? Work with a partner and discuss your ideas.

2 Work with a partner and discuss the following.

- the advantages and disadvantages of your country's education system
- the positive and negative aspects of your own educational experiences

READING

3 Which of the following are important to learn at school?

- important dates in history, e.g. battles
- the names of capital cities
- times tables, e.g. $4 \times 7 = 28$
- scientific formulae, e.g. $E = mc^2$
- spelling
- mental arithmetic, e.g. adding up numbers in your head
- poems and excerpts from literature

4 What techniques do you have for learning any of the above? Tell a partner.

5 What do you understand by the term 'rote learning'? Scan the article to check your answer.

6 Read the article. In which paragraph does the writer:

- argue** that it is pointless to memorise significant historical facts?
- claim** that rote learning is often used by professionals?
- comment** that there is an educational split in the world?
- conclude** that putting knowledge into practice is the most important thing?
- deny** that there are no positive aspects to rote learning?
- point out** that rote learning is considered old-fashioned?
- suggest** that learning alone is often boring?

7 Is the writer positive, negative or undecided about rote learning? Do you agree with the writer? Why?/ Why not?

Education is not about developing your interpersonal skills, but about learning facts.

There is no doubt that education involves learning new information and I agree with the second part of the phrase, however, almost every studying process is held in schools where students spend a lot of time together. Also some tasks may require team work. And it's sometimes almost impossible to study without any help. Thus, we can conclude that developing one's interpersonal skills is a vital part of education.